

FitCue

Reducing Constraint Friction in Fitness

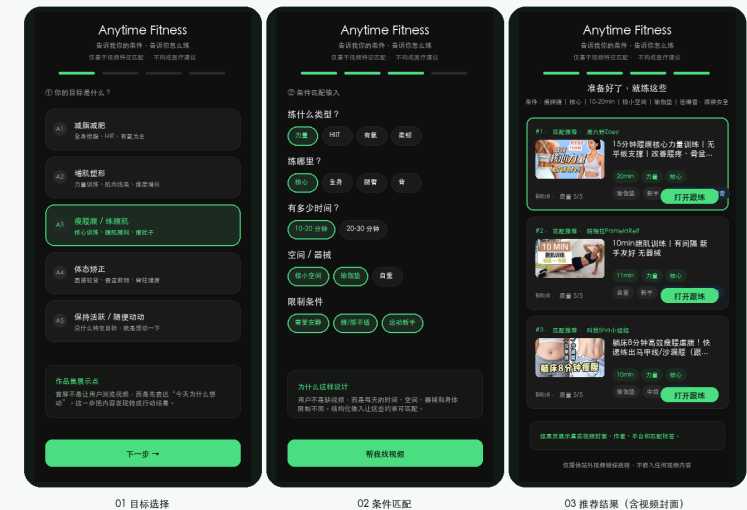
People do not need more workout videos. They need confidence that today's workout is feasible, safe, and worth starting.

Role & Scope

Product lead / founder-style discovery across problem framing, research synthesis, competitor analysis, prototype direction, validation design and go / no-go business judgement.

FitCue 真实网页产品截图

来自现有视频推荐产品：条件选择、约束输入、带视频封面的推荐结果。



1. Context & Problem

From content discovery to daily feasibility.

Context

Fitness content is abundant across YouTube, TikTok, Bilibili, Keep and creator channels. At first glance, users can search for almost any workout.

Problem Statement

The blocker is not supply. It is confidence: can I safely and realistically follow this workout under today's constraints?

User quote reframing

"I want to work out today, but I do not know which video I can safely and realistically follow under my current constraints."

Recurring Constraints

- Only 10-20 minutes available before the window closes.
- Small room, hotel room, dorm room, bedroom corner or living room.
- No jumping because of noise, neighbours, family or recovery needs.
- No equipment, or only a yoga mat, dumbbells or resistance bands.
- Returning after pregnancy, injury, illness or years away from exercise.

2. Research & Segment Narrowing

The strongest product decision was choosing who not to serve first.

Thesis review

Pressure-tested whether FitCue is solving a real user pain or simply adding a recommendation layer. The strongest argument: video platforms optimise watch time, while FitCue optimises workout completion.

Segment analysis

Standard gym-goers have stable routines and weak need for another tool. Stronger segments are users whose conditions change: travellers, new mothers, dorm students and midlife restarters.

Competitive scan

Fitness apps are strong at plans, creator content or tracking, but weak at matching public videos to specific constraints. Fitbod is adjacent, but keeps the behaviour loop in-app.

Target Segment Matrix

Stable routine

Standard gym-goers. Lower need for a separate recommendation layer.

Changing conditions

Travellers, dorm students and small-space users. Conditions change by day.

Low safety concern

Search speed matters more than trust signals.

High safety concern

New mothers and midlife restarters need confidence before starting.

3. Insight, Hypothesis & Strategy

The product became clearer when the goal changed from more content to fewer, safer choices.

Insight

Users do not need more fitness content. They need confidence that today's workout fits their constraints.

Hypothesis

If FitCue can translate daily constraints into 1-3 safe, feasible workout recommendations, then constraint-changing users will be more likely to start and return when conditions change again.

MVP Direction

- Mobile-first web app / PWA
- Structured inputs for time, space, equipment and restrictions
- 1-3 public video links with match reasons and safety labels

Strategic Trade-offs

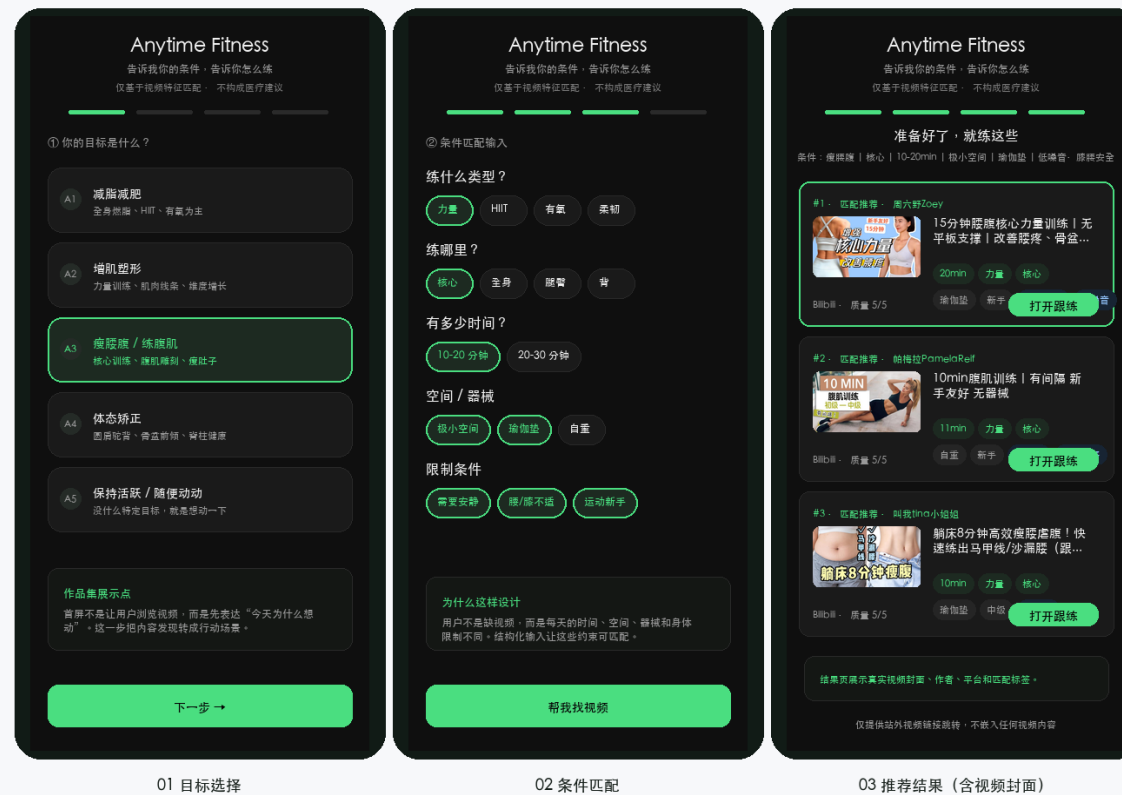
AI fitness coach	High trust, safety and technical risk for first validation	DEFER
Original workout content	Slow, expensive and distracts from the core assumption	DEFER
Training plan app	Competes with mature habit and tracking products	DEFER
Constraint-based video matching	Fastest path to test whether structured constraints beat search	CHOOSE

4. Prototype Evidence

Current screenshots are placeholders and can be replaced with final product images later.

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Placeholder note: these images show the existing web product flow and video-cover result cards. Replace the image files with final screenshots when ready, then regenerate the PDF.

5. Validation, Learning & Next Steps

No traction overclaiming - the next step is real behavioural validation.

Validation Signals

Problem-segment fit

Early assumption testing suggested higher need among users whose conditions changed often or whose safety concerns made video choice risky.

Concept clarity

The positioning became stronger around "what can I safely do today?" rather than generic fitness video recommendation.

Business realism

The user problem is real, but the link-based model has weak moat, low ARPU potential and strong substitutes.

Concierge MVP Plan

1 Diary

20 users record workout constraints for two weeks.

2 Manual recs

10 complex-constraint users receive manual recommendations.

3 Measure

Completion, repeat requests, safety trust and link-out acceptance.

4 Decide

Expand library, test paid filters, or keep as lightweight SEO tool.

Learning: Reducing decision friction can be more valuable than adding content. The right experience should feel like relief: one workout the user can actually do today.